

SECURITY WATCH

iOS Trustjacking vulnerability

Researchers from Symantec have found a new loophole in iOS that uses one of its features to allow attackers permanent control over iOS devices. When an iPhone user connects their phone to a MacOS device, the device prompts the user to decide whether to trust this computer or not (the phone charges regardless). Once the user grants this trust, it has been discovered that the trusted computer can still access the iPhone even after the phone has disconnected from the computer - as long as it is on the same WiFi network.

Even beyond the WiFi network, the phone will remain accessible if the computer shares the same VPN. You might think that this would require a pretty high degree of social engineering to qualify as a proper hack, but public charging ports could easily be hiding actual computer ports behind them. The fix that Apple has brought in has been half hearted, the computer user must enter the passcode of the phone it is connecting to. Symantec researchers believe that a better solution would be to disable the guilty "iTunes Wi-Fi sync" feature altogether. <https://dgit.in/iOSTrust>

MOBILE WATCH

Doogee Mix 4

Doogee has been a fairly regular feature in our mobile watch section, thanks to its cheap and super-thin bezel smartphones over the years. While they've been pretty good designs, they haven't been innovative on their own. Its new Mix 4 changes that by defying the current notch trend and instead incorporating a sliding mechanism. With this nod to devices from the 90s, the Mix 4 is able to provide a notchless, bezel less display that will prove to be a solid contender for the best screen-to-body ratio ever at 97%. For reference, the iPhone X is at 83%.

At 11mm the phone is thicker than its present day counterparts, but that is expected due to the sliding design. The design suffers from one con though - the slider also ends up blocking the light sensor and the speaker when shut. According to Arun Maini, also known as YouTuber Mrwhosetheboss, the guy who got his hands on the phone - the company plans to use a Snapdragon processor. The device is likely to go on sale towards the end of this year.



APP WATCH

Grasshopper



Google employees, as a part of an incubator, have created an app to help people learn how to code in an easy way. Grasshopper, named after computer scientist Grace Hopper, is aimed to teach the basics of Javascript to practically anyone who can use a phone.

The app starts off by checking your familiarity with code. Choosing to go for the absolute basic mode will start you off with basic lessons and questions about coding before moving on to tutorials. These tutorials are more like games that let you tap the right bit of code and then hit the play button to see the output. Mostly, the objective is to match your output to the example given.

You can also set a learning schedule according to your preferences, going



as frequent as daily or as rare as twice per week - or skip reminders altogether (although having a schedule always helps). There are helpful pointers between lessons and quizzes that explain particular concepts like functions to you. You keep earning points that add up to a total score, adding an element of gamification to

the whole thing. Give this one a shot, regardless of your previous experience with coding.

Notifix



Smartphone notifications can get cluttered in no time. Notifix is a notification manager that can help you with that by grouping notifications together into relevant categories like Social, Promotion and Primary.



Replika



Replika is a chatbot app that lets you create your own AI personality and chat with it, teaching it more about yourself over time and allowing to generate meaningful, relevant conversation with you. Give it a shot.



Rundogo



You have tons of apps to track your workouts but what about your pet dog? Rundogo is an app that tracks both your and your pets workouts, be it dog running (canicross), through mushing and biking to a quick evening walk.

